

[Summative #2]  
Cyrano Critical Lens Analysis

**Original Work** (*Drop photos if you'd rather not type.*)

Passage B

Through a psychological lens, it is revealed how Cyrano's lifestyle is controlled by his pride and honor. He describes himself as "too proud to be a parasite"(Rostand 2.88). This phrase reveals how his core thinking is also based on self-sufficiency. This same living style is also described when he says "I stand, not high it may be-but alone!"(Rostand 2.88). He also says how he likes "To walk in my own way and be alone". These quotes show how even though living by himself may not be the best, he views it as preferable to being with others. These passages relate to self-sufficiency as they describe the benefits of being alone. Even though he acknowledges that he may not be very rich or wealthy, his pride prevents him from asking others for help. He refuses to "Seek for the patronage of some great man", or to "Seek introductions, favors, [or] influences", which shows how much his pride affects his lifestyle (Rostand 2.88). A reason that he may not wish to have wealth is because he describes his ideal outcome as "be[ing] satisfied with flowers, / With fruit, with weeds even; but gather them / In the one garden you may call your own"(Rostand 2.88). Cyrano simply wishes to be alone and self-sufficient.

Passage C

Through a marxist lens, it is revealed that Cyrano believes how materialism and wealth do not equate with power. He describes a "soul clothed in shining armor, hung / With deeds for decorations", and he also describes how his "adornments" are on his soul instead of being physically worn (Rostand 1.37-38). These passages show how he believes that outside appearances do not contribute to how successful or powerful you are. He believes that actions and behavior are what contributes to how power is spread throughout the world. This means that he does not equate wealth with power, and believes that even though he may not "dress up like a popinjay", he still has "gems unseen"(Rostand 1.37-38).

One Thing I'm **Proud** Of:

- Successfully using both the marxist and the psychological lens to analyze Cyrano.

One Thing I Want to **Improve** On:

- Repetitive sentence structures: i.e. He [verb].

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**Revised Work**

(Pick 3-4 spots to showcase the original and the revised version. Aim for significant improvement, not just cosmetic improvements like spelling and grammar.)

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[1] ORIGINAL: Through a marxist lens, it is revealed that Cyrano believes how materialism and wealth do not equate with power. He describes a “soul clad in shining armor, hung / With deeds for decorations”...

[1] REVISION: Analyzed through a Marxist lens, Cyrano’s rhetoric rejects the traditional class structures of his society by eliminating the relationship between wealth and power. Rather than defining status through material wealth, he creates an alternative hierarchy influenced by personal merit and integrity, by imagining an individual with a “soul clad in shining armor, hung / With deeds for decorations”...

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[2] ORIGINAL: He also says how he likes "To walk in my own way and be alone". These quotes show how even though living by himself may not be the best, he views it as preferable to being with others. These passages relate to self-sufficiency as they describe the benefits of being alone.

[2] REVISION: He also declares a desire “To walk in my own way and be alone”, which shows how he chooses to embrace isolation. Even though total independence brings hardships, Cyrano chooses solitude over the many compromises of a relationship, and he even describes his isolated lifestyle to have absolute self-sufficiency.

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[3] ORIGINAL: Even though he acknowledges that he may not be very rich or wealthy, his pride prevents him from asking others for help. He refuses to "Seek for the patronage of some great man", or to "Seek introductions, favors, [or] influences", which shows how much his pride affects his lifestyle.

[3] REVISION: While Cyrano admits that he has a lack of material wealth, his pride functions as a psychological defence mechanism that prevents him from receiving help. His refusal to “Seek for the patronage of some great man” or pursue “introductions, favors [or] influences” demonstrates that he views reliance on the elite as a form of moral degradation, preferring poverty over a compromised identity.

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[4] ORIGINAL: This means that he does not equate wealth with power, and believes that even though he may not "dress up like a popinjay", he still has "gems unseen"(Rostand 1.37-38).

[4] REVISION: This means that he does not view wealth as giving power, and his refusal to “dress up like a popinjay” to refuse aristocratic standards shows how he views the currency of honor to hold more weight than any superficial currency.